



Merchant Marine **Notice**

Panama Maritime Authority
General Directorate of Merchant Marine
Control and Compliance Department

F-34
(DCCM)
V.04

NAVIGATIONAL NOTICE FOR FISHING AREAS ÁREAS AND CHINA COASTAL WATER

No: **MMN-09/2026**

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1. The purpose of this Merchant Marine Notice is to inform shipowners, operators, and masters that the Zhejiang MSA of China Maritime Safety Administration of the People's Republic of China (P.R.C.) has issued "Navigational Notices for Fishing Areas" aimed at enhancing navigational safety and improving overall safety conditions in these waters.
 2. This Administration reminds all masters of vessels flying the Panamanian flag to take into account the above-mentioned Navigational Notices when navigating in the coastal waters of China, area characterized by:
 - Heavy maritime traffic;
 - Intensive fishing vessel activity;
 - Abundant fishery resources;
 - Complex meteorological and hydrological conditions.
 3. It has been reported that a high concentration of fishing vessels is present China's coastal waters, creating a complex navigational environment and increasing the risk of collision. In view of the above, ship owners, operators, masters, and deck officers are strongly advised to:
 - Maintain a proper and effective lookout at all times, in accordance with the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (COLREGs);
 - Strictly comply with watch keeping requirements under the STCW Convention;
 - Exercise enhanced vigilance in areas of dense fishing activity;
 - Make full and effective use of all available navigational equipment;
 - Continuously monitor surrounding traffic and fishing vessel movements;
 - Take early and appropriate action to avoid close-quarters situations;
 - Consider the limited maneuverability and possible unpredictable behavior of fishing vessels;



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- Ensure that bridge teams are adequately briefed on the specific risks associated with navigation in these areas.
- 4. All vessels are urged to strictly follow applicable international regulations and best practices of good seamanship in order to ensure safe navigation and reduce the risk of incidents and casualties.
- 5. Shipping companies are encouraged to incorporate the risks associated with navigation in high-density fishing areas into their Safety Management Systems (SMS), including:
 - Risk assessments for operations in such areas;
 - Guidance to masters and officers;
 - Training and awareness measures for seafarers.
- 6. Our Administration urges shipowners, operators, and masters to review the information provided in this Notice. Attached to this Merchant Marine Notice are the “Navigational Notices for Fishing Areas,” which include detailed guidance on safe navigation and the operational characteristics of fishing vessels in China coastal waters.

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Inquiries concerning the subject of this Merchant Marine Notice or any other request should be forward to:

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